

Preparing for an IEP meeting

An IEP meeting is where you and your child's school team plan special education services. You are an equal member of that team. Use this checklist before, during and after the meeting.

Before the meeting

- ☐ Ask for copies of any new assessment reports a few days before the meeting, so you have time to read them.
- ☐ Write down your child's strengths and your top two or three priorities for the year.
- ☐ Gather reports from therapists, such as your child's BCBA or speech therapist, that you want the team to consider.
- ☐ Ask for an interpreter if you would prefer to communicate in another language.
- ☐ Decide whether to bring someone with you, such as a partner, friend or advocate.

During the meeting

- ☐ Share your child's strengths and your priorities early in the meeting.
- ☐ Ask how each goal will be measured and how often you will get progress reports.
- ☐ Ask what services, supports and accommodations your child will receive, and how often.
- ☐ If something is unclear, ask the team to explain it in plain language.
- ☐ Take notes, or ask the person with you to take them.

After the meeting

- ☐ You do not have to sign at the meeting. You can take the IEP home to read before you decide.
- ☐ If you agree with some parts and not others, ask the team how to note that.
- ☐ Keep a copy of the signed IEP in your family folder.
- ☐ Check in with the teacher a few weeks later to see how the plan is working.

Questions about the IEP process? Email info@autismkin.com.